

COLTON PLANTE

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SUMMARY

Technical sales leader with 6 years owning the full sales cycle for complex, multi-stakeholder enterprise accounts — \$3.4M+ in annual revenue at 40%+ gross margin, top-quartile rep company-wide — and founder of an agentic AI company designing, demoing, and deploying production AI systems. Combines consultative, trusted-advisor selling with hands-on technical depth (agents, RAG, LLM fine-tuning, orchestration) to establish credibility with technical decision makers and translate GenAI capability into business value.

EXPERIENCE

Clea Solutions — Founder

Charlotte, NC | Dec 2025 – Present

Agentic AI systems for construction & distribution businesses — on-premise, grounded, human-in-the-loop.

- Lead customer discovery with construction and distribution operators — leveraging 6 years of channel relationships to map document-heavy workflows (PO entry, quoting, email operations) to agentic AI solutions and clear value propositions.
- Build and run proof-of-concept iterations end to end — live demos of a document-processing agent, a fine-tuned email model, and an agent-governance console — owning the prototype-to-production lifecycle that moves prospects from evaluation to adoption.
- Translate agentic architectures (agents, RAG/grounding, human-in-the-loop validation, on-prem inference) into plain-language business cases for non-technical owners and operations leaders — and into credible technical detail for developers.
- Engineered the systems personally: end-to-end LLM fine-tuning pipeline (QLoRA via TRL/PEFT, quantized to GGUF, served with llama.cpp) and an agent orchestration & governance layer on Azure AI with Microsoft Entra ID; evaluated orchestration frameworks including LangGraph.

Trinity Surfaces (formerly Trinity Tile) — Sales Representative, Carolinas Territory

Charlotte, NC | Jun 2020 – Present

- Own the full sales cycle — prospecting, discovery, technical spec-in, quoting, pricing negotiation, close, and post-sale resolution — producing \$3.4M+ in annual revenue at 41–43% gross margin (\$3.28M in 2023; \$3.42M in 2025).
- Ranked #8 of 32 sales representatives company-wide in 2025 revenue (\$2.7M billed, \$1.26M gross margin) as a single-rep, multi-state territory.
- Act as trusted advisor to technical decision makers — architects, designers, and GC project teams — winning product specifications on commercial construction projects with multi-month, multi-stakeholder sales cycles.
- Manage complex enterprise accounts and national rollouts (including Morgan Stanley office locations in NY, CA, and AL), and expanded existing accounts with new product lines from zero to \$2.8M cumulative sales across 150+ accounts.
- Hired mid-COVID with a zero book of business; built the territory's sales playbook from scratch — prospecting cadence, spec-driven selling motion, and margin discipline that sustained 40%+ gross margins for six consecutive years.

Travel Country Outdoors — E-Commerce & Amazon Channel Manager

Altamonte Springs, FL | 2013 – 2020

- Grew Amazon channel sales 200% year-over-year (2018–2019) and launched a new fulfillment warehouse, opening a second e-commerce channel for the family retail business.

EDUCATION

Rollins College, Crummer Graduate School of Business — MBA, 2020 • Entrepreneurial Scholar of Distinction; consulted for NASA's patent-commercialization program

Florida State University — B.S. Entrepreneurship, 2018 • Florida State Football (2015–2018), All-ACC Academic Honor Roll

SKILLS

Sales: Full sales cycle ownership • Enterprise & multi-stakeholder accounts • Consultative / solution selling • Proof-of-concept & demo management • Pricing negotiation & deal structuring • Territory & pipeline management • Trusted-advisor relationship building • Customer insights to product feedback

Agentic AI & Technical: Agentic system design • RAG & grounding • LLM fine-tuning (QLoRA/LoRA, TRL, PEFT) • Local/on-prem inference (llama.cpp, GGUF) • Agent orchestration & governance (Azure AI, Microsoft Entra ID; LangGraph evaluation) • Prompt/context engineering • Python • TypeScript/React/Next.js • Claude Code